

Cat Body Signals



What their body and mood are telling you

Body condition, at a glance

Too thin

Ribs/spine easily felt, no fat cover

Ideal

Ribs felt with slight fat cover, visible waist

Overweight

Ribs hard to feel, no visible waist

Reading the signals

Happy looks like

- ♥ A slow blink aimed at you
- ♥ A relaxed, upright or gently swaying tail
- ♥ Kneading with their paws
- ♥ A relaxed, slightly open resting posture

Stressed looks like

- ♥ Flattened or swiveling ears
- ♥ A puffed-up or low, tucked tail
- ♥ Dilated pupils with a stiff body
- ♥ Excessive grooming in one spot

A few enrichment ideas

- ♥ Feather wand play for a few minutes a day satisfies natural hunting instincts and burns energy
- ♥ A cardboard box fort gives them a safe, enclosed place to hide, nap, and pounce from
- ♥ A window perch lets them bird-watch for hours — easy mental stimulation with zero effort from you
- ♥ A puzzle feeder turns mealtime into a rewarding little challenge instead of a 30-second gulp



Cat Must-Knows



1

Kittens eat 3-4 small meals a day; adults do best with 2 meals at regular times

2

Never feed onions or garlic (they damage red blood cells) or chocolate (its theobromine is toxic to cats)

3

A litter box should be at least 1.5x your cat's body length — one per cat, plus one extra

4

Book a first vet check-up within the first week or two of coming home

5

A cat's purr vibrates at a frequency linked to promoting bone and tissue healing

Bonus fun fact

Domestic cats share about 95% of their DNA with tigers.

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Cat Emergency & Prep

What to watch for, and how to get ready



Call the vet if you see

- ♥ Not eating or drinking for 24 hours
- ♥ Repeated vomiting or diarrhea
- ♥ Straining in the litter box or going outside it suddenly
- ♥ Hiding much more than usual, or sudden behavior changes
- ♥ Coughing, labored breathing, limping, or crying when touched

If something risky gets eaten

Call your vet or the ASPCA Animal Poison Control Center:
(888) 426-4435 — available 24/7

